

Seawall height in Tequesta

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

TEQUESTA · PALM BEACH COUNTY

4

ft NAVD88

New and substantially rebuilt seawalls in Tequesta need a cap of at least 4 ft NAVD88. Repairs under 50% of replacement cost are exempt.

The detail

ZONE X / X500	Min 4 ft NAVD88; max 6 in. above grade or 4.5 ft NAVD88, whichever is greater - Sec. 76-33(3)
FEMA SFHA/CHHA WITH BFE	Min 4 ft NAVD88; max 6 in. above grade or 5 ft NAVD88, whichever is greater - Sec. 76-33(3)
APPLIES TO	New walls and repairs of 50% or more of replacement cost - Sec. 76-33
RETURNS/DRAINAGE	Cap above neighbor grade needs wall return and drainage plan - Sec. 76-33(4)
RIPRAP/MANGROVES	100% facing on new/replaced walls - Sec. 76-34
WHO MAY BUILD A NEW WALL	Only to stabilize disturbed shorelines or replace deteriorated walls. Natural shorelines and riprap revetments need a variance under Sec. 76-7, with evidence the shoreline is disturbed - Sec. 76-32(6)
HOW THE 50% IS MEASURED	The community development director keeps a list of typical cost per running foot for each type of wall - Sec. 76-33(7)
MANGROVE MONITORING	Planting plan at final inspection, a time-zero report within 30 days, then annual photos for five years; replant if under 80% survive. A recent sea grass study (no older than half a year) can excuse riprap - Sec. 76-34, 76-36(b)-(g)

Where this comes from: Village of Tequesta Code, Ch. 76 Waterway Control, Art. IV, Sec. 76-33 (Ord. 8-24, 11-14-2024); Secs. 76-32, 76-36

Verified: 2026-10. Rules change — check the date above against today.

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3 Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4 Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.